

ATLIQ MEDIA · CODEBASICS RPC #21

Tamil Nadu Assembly Election 2026

AtliQ Media — Neutral Election Briefing

METRIC DEFINITIONS

ECI public data only · 234 constituencies · 2021 vs 2026

Generated: May 28, 2026 · Descriptive analysis · No predictions, no causal claims

3 · METRIC DEFINITIONS

Metric Definitions

Metric definitions — TN Assembly 2021 vs 2026

Use these consistently across **notebook**, **dashboard**, **deck**, and **video**.

Valid votes (per AC, per year)

```
valid_votes = SUM(votes) WHERE UPPER(party) ≠ 'NOTA'
```

Winner

Candidate with maximum `votes` among non-NOTA rows for that `ac_number`.

Vote share (%)

```
vote_share = 100 * candidate_votes / valid_votes  
winner_share = vote share of winner
```

Margin of victory (%)

```
margin_pct = 100 * (winner_votes - runner_up_votes) / valid_votes
```

Flip

```
flip = (winner_party_norm_2026 ≠ winner_party_norm_2021)
```

Requires `party_normalize.csv`. Report raw-label flip count separately if it differs.

Seat count

Count of ACs where `winner_party_norm` equals party X. Alliances only if explicit mapping table is published in README.

Join key

Always `ac_number` (1-234). Do not join on `constituency` name alone.

Turnout

- 2021: from starter CSV `turnout` column (constituency-level, repeated per row).
- 2026: **not in starter pack** — source from ECI portal; record scrape date in `data/external/`.

Advanced electoral indices (Deep Insights page)

All indices are descriptive measures from comparative-politics literature.

Effective Number of Parties (ENP) — Laakso & Taagepera (1979)

$$\text{ENP} = 1 / \sum p_i^2$$

where `pi` is each party's share of valid votes (0–1). ENP = 2 in a pure two-party contest; values of 3–4 indicate moderate fragmentation; > 4 is high.

Pedersen index of volatility — Pedersen (1979)

$$V = \frac{1}{2} \sum |p_i(t) - p_i(t-1)|$$

where shares are in percentage points. The index measures net vote-share churn between two elections. Values above ~20 are considered very high in stable democracies; 36 (TN 2021→2026) indicates structural realignment.

Gallagher Least-Squares disproportionality (LSq) — Gallagher (1991)

$$\text{LSq} = \sqrt{\frac{1}{2} \sum (s_i - v_i)^2}$$

where `si` is a party's seat share and `vi` is its vote share. Lower values mean seats match votes more closely. Compared with the older Loosemore–Hanby index, LSq weights large discrepancies more heavily — closer to international standard.

Representation gap (per party)

$$\text{gap_pp} = \text{seat_share_pct} - \text{vote_share_pct}$$

Positive values indicate first-past-the-post amplification of a party's vote into seats; negative values indicate under-representation.

Anti-incumbency rate

$$\text{anti_incumbency_pct} = 100 \times \sum \text{flip} / \text{total_seats}$$

within a slice (region, reserved category, or party 2021). Descriptive only — counts seats where the 2021 winning party did not retain the seat in 2026. No claim about voter motivation.

Race competitiveness

For each AC: combined vote share of top two candidates.

```
top2 = (votes_winner + votes_runner_up) / valid_votes * 100
```

Buckets used:

- **Multi-cornered** : $\text{top2} < 70\%$
- **Three-way** : $70\% \leq \text{top2} < 85\%$
- **Two-party** : $\text{top2} \geq 85\%$

District "full sweep"

A district where every assembly constituency it contains changed normalised winner between 2021 and 2026.

Constitutional context (descriptive)

- **Total seats:** 234 (TN Legislative Assembly, fixed under the Constitution and the Delimitation Act).
- **Reserved seats:** 44 SC and 2 ST in the current delimitation (Articles 332/334 of the Constitution; Delimitation Order 2008). The reserved set is identical across 2021 and 2026 in the starter file.
- **Voting system:** Simple-majority first-past-the-post. Winners can be elected on a plurality (< 50%) of valid votes — this is by design and not a defect.
- **NOTA:** A constitutional option since SC ruling 2013 (PUCL vs Union of India). Excluded from valid votes in margin and share computations to match ECI's "valid vote" reporting.

Sources

- Codebasics: `tn_2021_results.csv`, `tn_2026_results.csv`, `constituency_master.csv`
- ECI: <https://results.eci.gov.in/>
- 2021 lineage: Trivedi Centre / ECI (per `metadata.txt`)
- Indices: Laakso & Taagepera (1979), Pedersen (1979), Gallagher (1991)